locally, the doses which they were willing to spare were very limited. All in all, by this time it became absolutely clear to the members of NEGVAC that if India had any chance to vaccinate its population in a relatively short time frame comparable to large, developed nations, we would have to become self-sufficient and run our own programmes with minimum reliance on importing vaccines.

11 SEPTEMBER 2020

INDIA | 9,57,854 ACTIVE CASES | 78,087 DEATHS

WORLD | 63,58,014 ACTIVE CASES | 10,08,805 DEATHS

With the changing need in management of the pandemic, the originally formed 11 empowered groups were reconstituted into six: mostly clubbing functions of two groups into one. Empowered Group (EG) 1, headed by Dr Paul, would look into medical infrastructure and COVID-19 management plan. EG2, headed by the secretary of the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, would work on ensuring the availability of essential medical equipment and augmenting human resources. EG3, headed by Amitabh Kant, would be responsible for coordinating with the private sector, NGOs and international organizations for COVID-19 response. EG4, headed by the secretary of Department of Economic Affairs, would be responsible for managing economic and welfare measures. EG5, led by the secretary of Information and Broadcasting, would be responsible for handling information, communication, public awareness, public grievances and data management. And lastly, EG6, headed by the secretary of Home Affairs, would look at strategic issues related to COVID-19 management.

India saw cases peaking at about 90,000 new cases per day in September. However, India, confident in its capacity building of healthcare infrastructure and availability of essential supplies, continued to open up businesses to revive the economy. The last quarter, April to June, had seen a 7 per cent contraction in comparison to the same quarter in the previous